Unit 8 Planning and Development Politics



Learning Objectives

- To understand the meaning, evolution and objectives of planning.
- To trace the formation of the Planning Commission of India; to study the composition and functioning of the Commission.
- To examine the role of the Planning Commission towards achieving the ideals enshrined in the Indian constitution.
- To discuss the formation of NITI Aayog and to understand its composition and functioning.
- To understand the process of industrialization in India and to examine the role of the government in industrial development and regulation.
- To trace the process of land reforms in India.
- To examine the introduction of green revolution in India and to study its impact on the Indian economy.
- To discuss about white revolution in India and to examine its achievements.

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8.1 Planning: Meaning, Evolution and Objectives

Planning before Independence

Planning exists in all economies and political systems. A planned system aims at the systematic utilization of the available resources of the state for a long term progress. It is a process where the state aims to increase its output, national dividend, employment and also enhance the social welfare of the people. In such a system, all productive units in a country use their resources according to the directives of the government which is the central authority for development. It also includes laying down targets for public and private enterprises by the state. The state regulates and controls the functioning of both the private and public enterprises. All economic activities of the State are regulated by the government for the progress of the nation and the welfare of the people.

The modern state assumes welfare functions. Unlike the olden days, when states were "police states" concerned only with the security of the population and law and order, the welfare states have a wider role to play. They not only give good governance but also ensure socio-economic justice to the people. The democratic form of government gives opportunities and scope to realise the welfare state objectives of the modern state. The state recommends and implements socio economic reforms so that nations can shed their backwardness and move towards development. In India,

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